

EVENT VENUES AND LEGACY

Planning for day two

What became of 30 Olympic, Expo and World Cup sites after the crowds left, and what the Gulf and Egypt can settle now for the venues they are building next



SIX NUMBERS FROM THE REPORT

156%	average real cost overrun of the Olympic Games from 1960 to 2016; every Games with data overran its budget
58%	of the seats in its seven new World Cup stadiums Qatar planned to remove; Lusail drew 84,517 to the Arab Cup final in December 2025, twice its planned legacy size
16%	of the London Aquatics Centre's Games seats kept for everyday use: 2,800 of 17,500
5,632	homes in Harumi Flag, Tokyo's former athletes' village, on about 18 hectares
80%+	of Expo 2020's buildings and infrastructure kept at Expo City Dubai, which reopened six months after the Expo closed
17%	of a 46,000-seat bowl filled by the Saudi Pro League's 2025-26 average crowd; ten new stadiums are planned for the 2034 World Cup

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

Heirstone Consulting advises master developers, sovereign and private investors, land agencies and tourism authorities across the Middle East and Africa on destinations, event sites and specialised real estate. This report uses public sources current in 2026: audit offices and government statistics, event organisers and legacy bodies, the Bureau International des Expositions, peer-reviewed studies, operator and developer disclosures, and the press where it quotes a primary party.

Where we have combined published figures to make a new one, such as homes per hectare, cost per seat or visits per hectare, the calculation and its inputs are shown and labelled Heirstone analysis. The report takes no view on the merits of any host or event; its subject is how event sites are planned for the years after.

SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

The day after an event is decided years before it opens

We followed 30 Olympic, Expo and World Cup sites from closing ceremony to 2026. The sites that reopened quickly had their landowner and their buyer or tenant fixed in contracts before the event. Where these were settled afterwards, the main reuse took between three and 22 years, and some sites are still waiting.

1 Contracts made before the event set the pace of reuse.

Lisbon's Expo site reopened as a city district 15 days after the fair closed, Expo City Dubai after six months and part of London's Olympic Park within a year. In each case the landowner and its buyers or partners were fixed in advance. Where the anchor or development partner came later, the main reuse took three to 22 years: Athens's Hellinikon venues waited 16 years for redevelopment.

2 Seats are the hardest asset to carry into day two.

London kept 16% of its Aquatics Centre seats by unbolting two temporary wings. Qatar planned to remove 58% of the seats in its seven new stadiums; by December 2025 we found no confirmed removal, and a run of follow-on tournaments was filling the larger bowls. Public partnerships can outweigh the build cost: Natal's commits the state to BRL 10m a month for 11 years, 3.3 times the stadium's reported build cost, including construction finance.

3 Homes are the most dependable legacy.

Athletes' villages convert because a flat still has a buyer once the event has gone. Paris is converting its village into 2,807 homes, with residents from 2025, and Tokyo's Harumi Flag holds 5,632. London sold its village for £825m before the Games, about £293,000 a home.

4 District legacies take decades, and the cost line comes first.

Sevilla TechPark reports 35,806 jobs on the Expo 92 site, 33 years on and two and a half times the 2009 figure. Milan's innovation district had realised about 35% of its investment programme nine years after its Expo. Meanwhile overruns are systematic: every Olympic Games with data has overrun, by 156% on average in real terms.

5 The Gulf's pipeline is large and still early enough to test.

Saudi Arabia's ten new 2034 stadiums add 508,505 seats, against Saudi Pro League average crowds of 7,736 to 8,355. Riyadh's Expo 2030 legacy plan houses 150,000 people at 25,000 per km², the density of London's East Village over an area 22 times larger. Egypt already holds about 255,000 seats in its three largest stadiums and staged the 2019 Africa Cup of Nations at five months' notice; its day-two task is to turn that record into a year-round calendar.

WHAT IT MEANS

Governments and land agencies should write the day-two owner, tenant and seat count into the host agreement, with a published reopening date.

Master developers should treat the village and the event estate as the first phase of a district and phase the rest on absorption measured in decades.

Investors and lenders should underwrite households and anchor leases, and treat seat revenue as event-day income.

30

sites in 17 countries in the Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark: 12 Olympic, 9 Expo and 9 World Cup

8

tests in the Heirstone day-two readiness scorecard, each tied to a benchmark case

<1 year

median time to the main post-event use where the owner and the use were fixed before the event



CHAPTER 1

01

The Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark

Twelve Olympic, nine Expo and nine World Cup sites, from Barcelona 1992 to Osaka 2025, followed from the closing ceremony to 2026.

Most writing on event legacy starts from the event: what it cost, how many came, what was promised. We started at the other end. For 30 sites we recorded what stands on the land today, who owns and runs it, how many people live or work there, and how long it took to get from the closing ceremony to the first permanent use.

The sample covers 17 countries. It includes the cases usually cited as successes, such as Barcelona, Lisbon and London, and those usually cited as failures, such as

Hellinikon in Athens and the Amazon arena in Manaus. It also includes the Gulf's two most recent mega-events, Expo 2020 Dubai and the 2022 World Cup in Qatar.

Two results stand out. The type of event largely sets the form of the legacy: Expos tend to become districts and World Cups leave stadiums. Within each type, the sites that reopened fastest were the ones whose owner and users were under contract before the event began.

THE BENCHMARK

Where the 30 sites are, and what they became

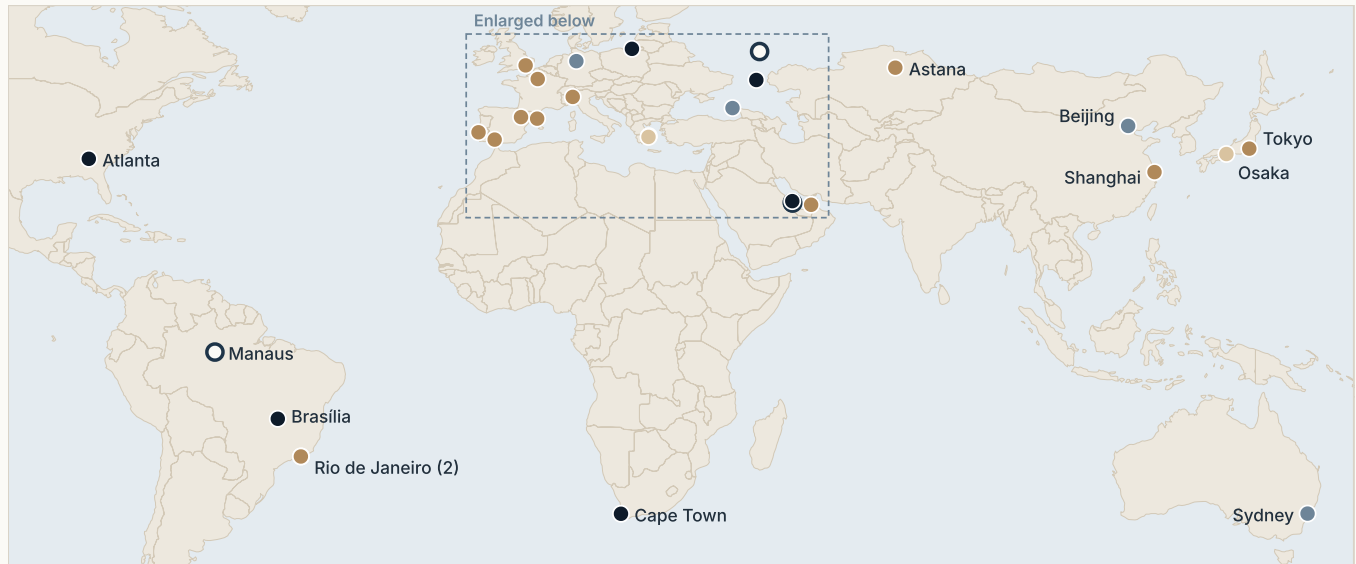
EXHIBIT 1

Twelve of the 30 sites became districts; ten are still mainly stadiums

Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark sites by legacy model, status at 2026

● District-led ● Anchor tenant or concession ● Venue cluster or event estate ● Cleared or temporary-first

○ Light use or conversion pending



LOWER PANEL

Europe, the Mediterranean and the Gulf, where 18 of the 30 sites lie.

SITES BY LEGACY MODEL

● District-led	12
● Anchor tenant or concession	6
● Venue cluster or event estate	6
● Cleared or temporary-first	2
○ Light use or conversion pending	4

Source: Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026, compiled from the BIE, SOLIDEO, LLDC, Sydney Olympic Park Authority, Arexpo, Sevilla TechPark, Lamda Development, Expo City Dubai and Wikipedia site records (table on page 6). Legacy model is a **Heirstone classification**. Positions for the Paris village (adjacent landmark) and Harumi (district centroid) are approximate.

Twelve sites became districts with homes, offices or campuses on the event land. Six are stadiums kept busy by an anchor tenant or a concession, and six are venue clusters or event estates that still mainly host sport, fairs and visitors. Two were cleared or are being cleared for new uses. Four are in light use or still waiting for a planned conversion.

THE BENCHMARK

Thirty sites, one table

Years to main use: calendar years from the event to the opening of the principal post-event use; 0 for stadiums with a club tenant from the start; for Sydney, venues and then homes. Area is the event site or legacy district as published. Legacy models as in Exhibit 1. n/v: not verified in public sources. n/a: not applicable. Planned figures are targets, not outcomes.

SITE AND EVENT	AREA (HA)	LEGACY MODEL	YEARS TO MAIN USE	HOMES OR RESIDENTS	JOBS OR ANCHOR	STATUS, 2026
OLYMPIC GAMES (12)						
Vila Olímpica Barcelona 1992	94	● District	n/v	c.2,000 flats	n/v	9,338 residents
Olympic Stadium Atlanta 1996	n/v	● Anchor tenant	under 1	none	Georgia State (2017)	University stadium
Olympic Park Sydney 2000	663	● Venue cluster	0; homes 11+	4,848 residents	26,000 jobs (plan)	15,000 homes planned
OAKA complex Athens 2004	n/v	● Venue cluster	0	none	n/v	In use; works to 2026
Hellinikon venues Athens 2004	620	● Cleared or temporary	16	homes planned	n/v	Venues demolished
Olympic Green Beijing 2008	n/v	● Venue cluster	0	none	n/v	Visitors; 2022 reuse
Olympic Park London 2012	227	● District	1 to 2	2,818 (East Village)	Here East; UCL East	Park open since 2014
Olympic Park Sochi 2014	n/v	● Venue cluster	0	n/v	n/v	F1 to 2021; club use
Barra Olympic Park Rio 2016	n/v	● Venue cluster	n/v	none	6,400 student places	Partly schools
Athletes' village Rio 2016	n/v	● District	n/v	3,604 flats	n/v	Sales n/v
Harumi Flag Tokyo 2020	18	● District	2.4	5,632 units	Ward schools (2024)	Occupied from 2024
Athletes' village Paris 2024	52	● District	1	2,807 homes	6,000 jobs (target)	Converting from 2025
WORLD EXPOS (9)						
Isla de la Cartuja Seville 1992	215	● District	5	n/v	35,806 jobs	Technology park
Parque das Nações Lisbon 1998	50	● District	0	22,382 residents	10,201 employed	Mature city district
Messe, Expo Plaza Hannover 2000	160	● Venue cluster	0	c.3,000 nearby	n/v	Trade fair in use
Ranillas meander Zaragoza 2008	25	● District	n/v	n/v	Offices (n/v)	Aquarium operating
Expo Park Shanghai 2010	523	● District	0 to 7	n/v	Arena; museums	Culture and park
MIND Milan 2015	110	● District	3 to 7	n/v	Hospital; campus	35% of plan invested
Expo site Astana 2017	25	● District	n/v	n/v	Financial centre	300,000+ visits a year
Expo City Dubai Dubai 2020	438	● District	0.5	35,000 planned	40,000 planned	COP28 host (2023)
Yumeshima Osaka 2025	155	● Cleared or temporary	pending	n/a	Resort by 2030	Pavilions dismantled
FIFA WORLD CUP STADIUMS (9)						
Cape Town Stadium 2010	18	● Anchor tenant	11	none	none	City grant ZAR 42m
Arena da Amazônia 2014	n/v	○ Light use or pending	none yet	none	none	12 matches in 2015
Mané Garrincha 2014	n/v	● Anchor tenant	5	none	n/v	Concessioned, 2019
Kaliningrad Stadium 2018	n/v	● Anchor tenant	0	n/v	n/v	Club home
Volgograd Arena 2018	n/v	● Anchor tenant	0	none	n/v	Cut to 43,000 seats
Mordovia Arena 2018	n/v	○ Light use or pending	0	none	n/v	No tenant after 2022
Stadium 974 2022	45	○ Light use or pending	3+	waterfront plan	n/v	Standing; used 2025
Lusail Stadium 2022	n/v	○ Light use or pending	3+	none	Community (plan)	Full bowl, Dec 2025
Al Bayt Stadium 2022	n/v	● Anchor tenant	0	none	Hotel, mall (plan)	Club home; full bowl

Source: Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026, compiled from BIE Expo pages; SOLIDEO; LLDC monitoring 2023-24; Sydney Olympic Park Authority Master Plan 2050; Lamda Development; Sevilla TechPark; Arexpo and TEHA Group (2025); Expo City Dubai master plan; INE census 2021 and ABS census 2021 via Wikipedia; Wikipedia site and venue articles (accessed 2026). Legacy model and years to main use are **Heirstone analysis**; inputs are listed in the notes.

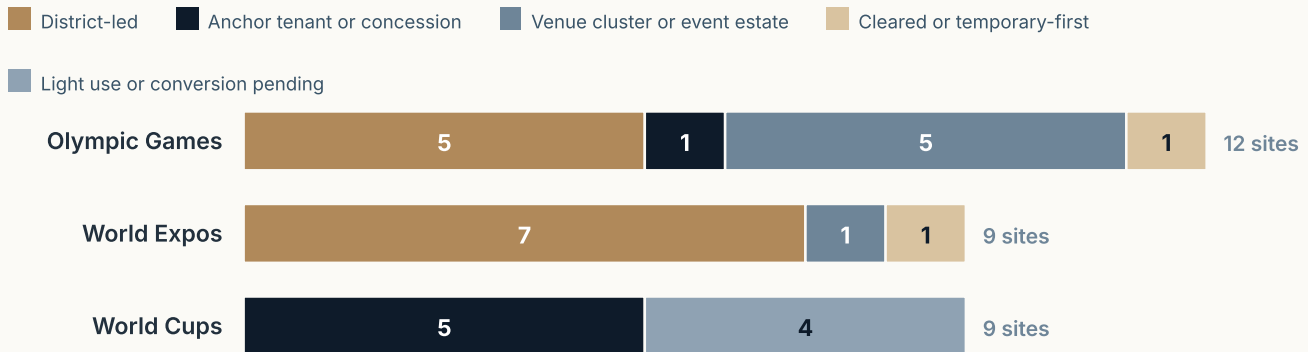
WHAT THE EVENT LEAVES

Expos turn into districts and World Cups leave stadiums. Olympic sites split between the two.

EXHIBIT 2

Seven of nine Expo sites became districts; none of the nine World Cup sites did

Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark sites by event type and legacy model, number of sites



Source: Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026. Heirstone classification of each site's principal use at 2026; see the table on page 6.

The form of the legacy follows the form of the event. An Expo occupies one contiguous site for six months and leaves a land bank: Lisbon, Seville, Milan, Astana and Dubai all turned theirs into districts, and only Hannover, which ran on an existing trade-fair estate, and Osaka, which is clearing its island for a resort, did not. A World Cup leaves a stadium in each host city. In our sample, five of the nine kept a club tenant or a concession and four are in light use or waiting for a conversion that has not yet happened.

Olympic sites split down the middle. The athletes' village is a housing project and behaves like one; the venue park behaves like a stadium

cluster. Barcelona, London, Tokyo and Paris made districts out of their villages, while Sydney, Athens, Beijing, Sochi and Rio kept venue parks that still depend on events and public funding.

This matters for planning because the day-two question differs by event. For an Expo host it is mainly about land absorption and for a World Cup host about tenants and seat counts; an Olympic host faces both, on different plots.

One anchor recurs at Olympic and Expo sites: education. Universities and schools took space at no fewer than seven of the 30 sites, in several cases as the first permanent tenant.

EDUCATION AS THE FIRST TENANT

Atlanta 1996	Stadium sold to Georgia State University and rebuilt for US\$52.8m (2017)
London 2012	UCL East and London College of Fashion (2023); Chobham Academy, 1,800 places (2013, per Wikipedia)
Rio 2016	Carioca Arena 2 to a federal institute (1,400 students, per Wikipedia); Arena 3 to a sports school (5,000)
Tokyo 2020	New Chuo Ward elementary and junior high schools at Harumi Flag (April 2024)
Paris 2024	Two school groups with 35 classes; 130-unit student residence used before, during and after
Milan 2015	University of Milan science campus; Human Technopole in the former Palazzo Italia
Astana 2017	An IT university and the Astana Hub IT park alongside the financial centre

CHAPTER 2

02

The budget
always moves

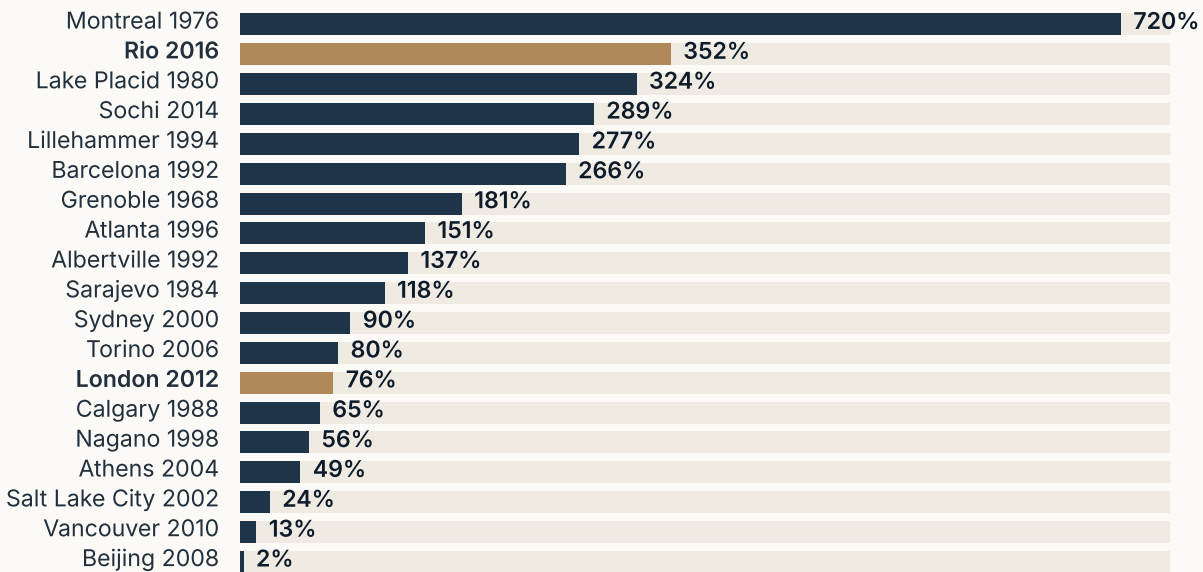
The Oxford Olympics Study is the longest consistent record of what the Games cost. Its 2016 edition found an overrun in every Games with data since 1960, averaging 156% in real terms with a median of 90%; the 2020 update put the average at 172%. Oxford's authors note that no other type of megaproject they have studied overruns every time.

For legacy planning the lesson is practical. A day-two vehicle that inherits debt from the event, or whose business plan assumes the bid budget, starts its life with a hole in it. The question to ask of any host plan is whether the day-two district still works at the outturn cost.

EXHIBIT 3

Every Games with data overran; Montreal by 720%, Beijing by 2%

Real cost overrun of the Olympic Games from bid to outturn, sports-related costs, %, 1968 to 2016 (19 Games with data)



Source: Flyvbjerg, Stewart and Budzier, The Oxford Olympics Study 2016 (Saïd Business School, July 2016); Flyvbjerg, Budzier and Lunn, Regression to the Tail (Environment and Planning A, September 2020) for Rio 2016, revised from 51%. Sports-related costs exclude wider infrastructure such as roads, rail and airports.

The median is more useful than the mean. Oxford found that it fell from 166% for Games held before 1999 to 51% for those after. Overruns have shrunk, yet a legacy vehicle should still be planned on an outturn well above the bid.

90%

median real overrun, all Games with data, 1960 to 2016

51%

median overrun for Games held after 1999, down from 166%

15 of 19

Games overran by more than 50% in real terms

COST AND WHAT IT BUYS

Cost figures keep moving after the event, and the venue-light model is the only one with recorded surpluses in our data

The first published cost of an event is rarely the last. Oxford put Rio 2016 at US\$4.6bn and a 51% overrun in 2016; four years later, with fuller data, the same team put it at US\$13.7bn and 352%, three times the first estimate. Japan's Board of Audit warned in 2018 that Tokyo's venue-related costs could exceed US\$25bn, against a final organising figure of ¥1.4 trillion, about US\$13bn. Any post-event cost quoted within three or four years of the closing ceremony should be treated as provisional.

Scope also needs care. Sochi 2014 cost RUB 1,524bn (US\$49.5bn) in its final budget, against an initial US\$12bn, but only about US\$10.8bn was directly related to the Games. In Qatar, estimates range from US\$8bn for the tournament to over US\$220bn including national infrastructure. Comparisons that

mix the two say little about the venues.

Expos show the same pattern. Hannover 2000 expected 40 million visitors and the BIE recorded 18.1 million; the fair lost DM 1.1bn. Milan's tickets raised €373.7m against €2,254.7m spent by the organising company from 2009 to 2015, about 17%. Osaka's venue budget rose from ¥185bn to ¥235bn, or 27%, before the gates opened.

The cases with surpluses used what was already there. Los Angeles 1984 built two new permanent venues, both sponsor-funded, and made a US\$232.5m surplus. Paris 2024 used 95% existing or temporary venues and its organising committee reported a €76m surplus. LA28 is building no new permanent venues, and Brisbane's 2019 feasibility study found 68% of the venues it needed already existed or could be upgraded.

3x

Oxford's revision of Rio 2016's sports-related cost between its 2016 and 2020 studies

€76m

organising surplus reported for Paris 2024, which used 95% existing or temporary venues

CAD 870m

estimated in 2024 to replace Montreal's Olympic Stadium roof, more than the CAD 770m the stadium cost by 1976

EXHIBIT 4

A seat in Manaus cost more than one in Beijing, and is used far less

Reported construction cost divided by event capacity, US\$ per seat as reported (nominal, not inflation-adjusted), with post-event use

Japan National Stadium	US\$20,561	Operator franchised, 2025
Fisht Stadium, Sochi	US\$16,937	Club tenant
Mané Garrincha, Brasília	US\$12,365	Concession from 2019
Cape Town Stadium	US\$9,360	Anchor tenant from 2021
Arena Pantanal, Cuiabá	US\$7,079	879 average in 2015
Mordovia Arena, Saransk	US\$6,750	No tenant after 2022
Arena da Amazônia	US\$6,290	Light use
Beijing National Stadium	US\$4,703	Tourism and events
Atlanta Olympic Stadium	US\$2,459	Converted at once

Source: Wikipedia venue articles citing organisers and press (accessed 2026): build costs as reported in US\$; capacities at the event (Arena Pantanal 41,390; Fisht 45,994; Japan National Stadium 68,089). Heirstone analysis. Costs are nominal and from different years and scopes, so differences of less than about a third should not be read as meaningful.

CHAPTER 3

03

Seats are the hardest asset

A stadium seat earns on event days, while a flat or an office earns every day of the year. That difference explains most of what happened to the venues in our benchmark.

The event sets the size. An Olympic opening ceremony or a World Cup semi-final needs a bowl that few cities fill more than a handful of times a year, and the seats are built for that peak. Afterwards the same seats have to be filled by a domestic club, a university team or a concert promoter whose crowd is a fraction of the tournament's.

The benchmark shows four ways out of a tournament-sized bowl. Where a venue takes none of them, it becomes a fixed cost for its public owner, which Exhibit 8 puts at about 1% to 2% of build cost a year.

1 Remove seats

London Aquatics Centre: 17,500 seats in Games mode, 2,800 when it reopened in 2014.

2 Sign a tenant

Cape Town: rugby anchor and naming rights in 2021; the city grant fell 31%.

3 Fill the calendar

Qatar: Asian Cup 2024, Arab Cup 2025, U-17 World Cup to 2029, Asian Games 2030.

4 Change the use

Rio: two arenas became schools, for 1,400 and 5,000 students according to Wikipedia. Atlanta: a university ground.

A World Cup qualifier at Arena da Amazônia drew 12,500 in 2021. The stadium has 42,924 seats.

The next three sections take the routes in turn: what seat removal achieved where it was carried out, what a booked calendar has done for Qatar's stadiums since 2022, and who pays when a venue takes none of the four.

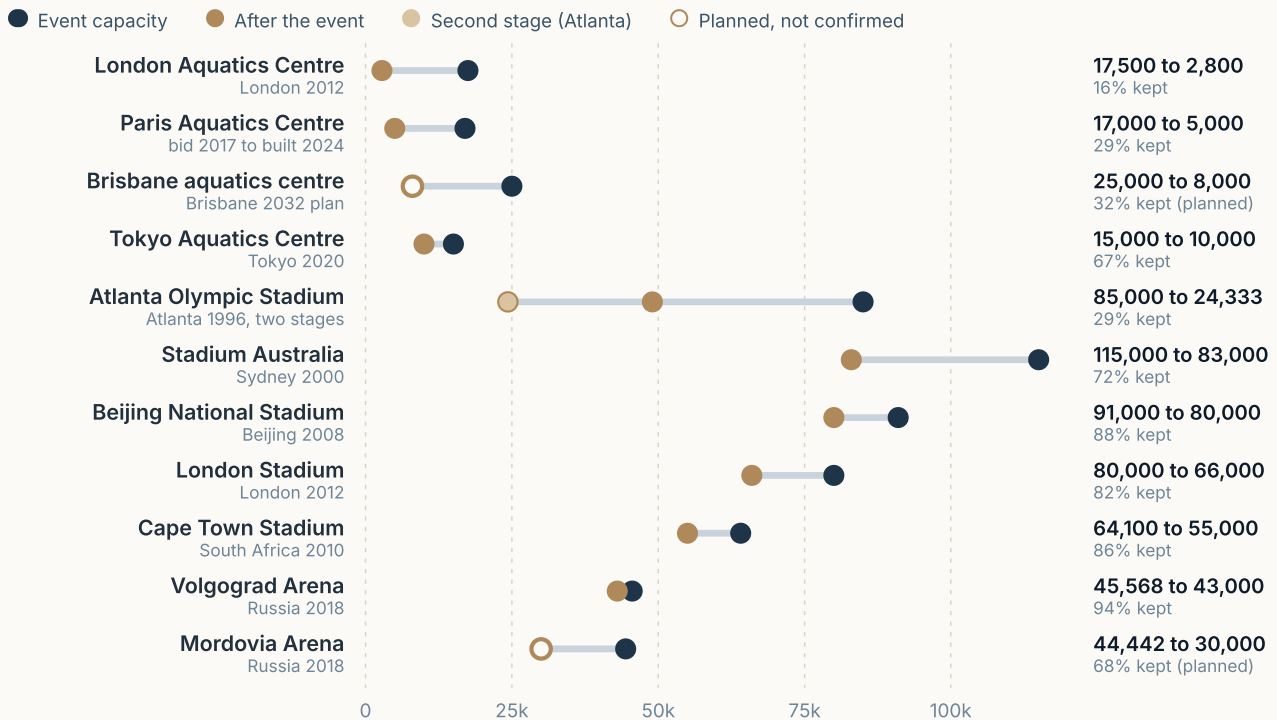
THE SEAT HAIRCUT

Downsizing happened where it was designed and paid for before the event

EXHIBIT 5

London kept 16% of its aquatics seats; most stadiums kept more than 80%

Seats at the event and after it, selected Olympic and World Cup venues



Source: Wikipedia venue articles (accessed 2026); NAO, London 2012 post-Games review (2012); SOLIDEO, Centre Aquatique Olympique; BBC Sport and ABC News via Wikipedia (Brisbane, March 2025). Stadium Australia after reconfiguration is given as 82,500 to 84,000 by different sources; we show about 83,000. Tokyo shows the reported legacy mode. **Heirstone analysis** of share kept.

London's Aquatics Centre is the clearest case. It seated 17,500 in Games mode and 2,800 afterwards, with 1,000 more for major events. The extra seats sat in two temporary wings whose frames were unbolted and sold, and the centre reopened to the public on 1 March 2014. London's 12,000-seat basketball arena, the largest temporary venue built for any Games, was dismantled by January 2013 and its seats sold to a football club.

Paris cut before it built. Its bid listed a 17,000-seat aquatics centre; SOLIDEO delivered 5,000 seats, a 71% cut, on a final budget of €176.0m, and the centre opened to the public in June 2025, about ten months after the Games. Brisbane plans to take its 2032 aquatics centre from 25,000 seats to 8,000.

Stadium conversions have mostly been modest: Beijing kept 88% of its seats and Cape Town 86%. The deeper cuts came with a tenant waiting. Atlanta's Olympic stadium became the 49,000-seat home of a baseball club straight after 1996, and in 2017 Georgia State University rebuilt it as a 24,333-seat football ground for US\$52.8m. Sydney spent A\$80m from 2001 to 2003 cutting Stadium Australia to about 83,000 seats, 12% of its A\$690m build cost.

Where removal was left as an intention, it slipped. Rio's Future Arena, designed to be taken down and rebuilt as schools, was still standing in November 2017 because no money had been budgeted to dismantle it.

QATAR AFTER 2022

Qatar planned to remove 58% of its new seats, and has so far filled them with a calendar of tournaments

EXHIBIT 6

Lusail drew 84,517 in December 2025, more than twice its planned legacy capacity

Qatar 2022 World Cup stadiums: published legacy plan against observed use to December 2025

STADIUM	TOURNAMENT SEATS	PLANNED LEGACY	PLANNED CUT	PLANNED DAY-TWO USE	OBSERVED, 2023 TO DECEMBER 2025
Lusail	88,966	40,000	55%	Schools, shops, cafés, sport, clinic	84,517 at the Arab Cup final, 18 December 2025
Al Bayt	68,895	32,000	54%	Five-star hotel, mall, sports facilities	Al-Khor SC home; 2023 Asian Cup and 2025 Arab Cup at full size
Ahmad bin Ali	45,032	21,000	53%	Club ground	Listed at 47,343 seats for the 2024-25 league
Education City	44,667	25,000	44%	University athletics	Asian Cup and Arab Cup; no reduction confirmed
Al Thumama	44,400	22,200	50%	Arena, sports clinic, hotel; seats donated	Al-Arabi SC tenant since 2023; no reduction confirmed
Al Janoub	44,325	20,000	55%	Al-Wakrah SC ground	To become an 8,200-seat arena for FIBA 2027
Stadium 974	44,089	0	100%	Dismantle and relocate; waterfront development	Still standing; Arab Cup matches, December 2025
Seven new stadiums	380,374	160,200	58%	Calendar: Asian Cup 2024 (average 29,565), Arab Cup 2025 (38,644), U-17 World Cup 2025-29, FIBA World Cup 2027, Asian Games 2030	

Source: Qatar 2022 Supreme Committee stadium pages; Wikipedia stadium and tournament articles citing FIFA, AFC and league data (accessed 2026). Planned cut and totals are Heirstone analysis; Al Thumama's legacy is taken as half its seats (the organiser's page describes a 20,000-seat arena). Khalifa International, the eighth venue, was an existing stadium with no planned cut.

Qatar published the most ambitious downsizing plan of any recent host. Across its seven new stadiums, 220,174 of 380,374 seats were to come out, many of them to be donated abroad, with hotels, shops, clinics and community space in the freed upper tiers. Stadium 974, built from 974 shipping containers, was to be dismantled entirely and its site redeveloped on the waterfront.

None of the sources we reviewed confirms a completed seat removal by December 2025. Lusail drew 84,517 to the Arab Cup final on 18 December 2025, and Ahmad bin Ali was listed at 47,343 seats for the 2024-25 league season against a planned 21,000. Stadium 974 hosted Arab Cup matches; its planned move to Uruguay for 2030 did not go ahead.

The calendar explains much of this. The 2023 Asian Cup, played in early 2024, averaged 29,565 a match and the

2025 Arab Cup 38,644, both above the 20,000 to 25,000 seats planned for four of the seven bowls. Qatar holds the FIFA U-17 World Cup every year from 2025 to 2029, the FIBA Basketball World Cup in 2027 and the Asian Games in 2030. In practice it has replaced seat removal with a booking programme, and has started to change use where the calendar asks for it: according to the published venue list for the 2027 FIBA World Cup, Al Janoub is to become an 8,200-seat basketball arena.

Two planning lessons follow. A demountable design creates an option, and the option is exercised only once a buyer and a funded removal contract are in place. A booked calendar postpones the day-two question until the bookings run out. For Qatar's larger bowls that point comes after 2030, when the domestic league and local events will have to carry them.

220,174

seats Qatar planned to remove from its seven new stadiums

38,644

average crowd at the 2025 Arab Cup, held in six of the 2022 stadiums

5

editions of the FIFA U-17 World Cup booked in Qatar, one a year from 2025 to 2029

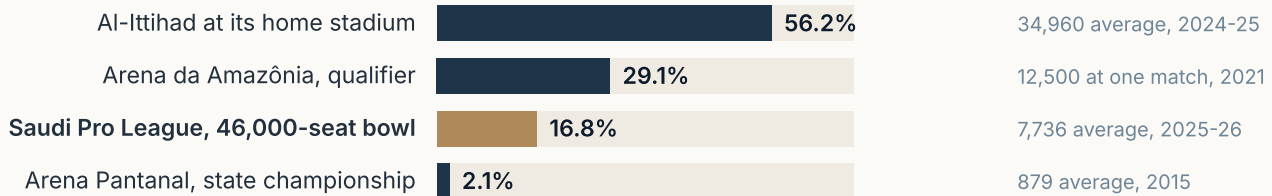
WHO PAYS FOR EMPTY SEATS

When league crowds fill a fraction of a tournament bowl, the public owner pays for the rest

EXHIBIT 7

Even the Saudi Pro League's best-supported club fills just over half its stadium

Average or single-match attendance as a share of capacity, %



Source: Wikipedia league and venue articles citing league and club data (accessed 2026). Al-Ittihad: 34,960 against 62,241 seats at King Abdullah Sports City. Arena da Amazônia 42,924; Arena Pantanal 42,788 (43,150 to 44,097 in Portuguese Wikipedia). The Arena Pantanal average is single-source. The 46,000 reference is the typical capacity of the new 2034 stadiums. **Heirstone analysis.**

Natal's Arena das Dunas was built as a public-private partnership. Rio Grande do Norte pays BRL 10m a month for the first 11 years, BRL 1.32bn in all and 3.3 times the BRL 400m build cost, and guarantees the operator a minimum profit. Cape Town took its stadium back in December 2010 after the operator cancelled the lease as non-viable. Only in 2021, with a rugby anchor tenant and a naming deal, did the stadium beat its revenue target, by 30%, and the city cut its grant by 31%.

London shows the cost of converting late. The stadium cost £429m to £486m to build, depending on the source, and £274m to convert for football from 2013 to 2016; the conversion's capital budget had risen from £190m to £323m. West Ham's £2.5m annual rent is about a third of 1% of build and conversion cost, against a forecast loss of £10m a year. Montreal finished paying for its 1976 stadium in November 2006, 30 years on.

EXHIBIT 8

In our sample, keeping a stadium open cost its owner about 1% to 2% of the build cost a year

Annual public payment, subsidy, loss or running cost after the event, and its share of build cost

VENUE	BUILD COST	ANNUAL COST AFTER THE EVENT	SHARE OF BUILD COST A YEAR	ANCHOR AND OPERATOR
Arena das Dunas, Natal	BRL 400m	BRL 120m a year in partnership payments for 11 years (BRL 10m a month)	30%	State guarantees the operator a minimum profit
Beijing National Stadium	US\$428m	About US\$9m maintenance a year	2.1%	No permanent club; tourism and events
Cape Town Stadium	ZAR 4.4bn	City grant of ZAR 61m, cut to ZAR 42m after the 2021 deals	1.4% to 1.0%	First operator quit in 2010; rugby anchor and naming rights from 2021
London Stadium	£486m + £274m	Forecast operating loss of £10m a year (2018)	1.3%	West Ham on a 99-year lease at £2.5m a year
Arena da Amazônia, Manaus	BRL 605m	Operating loss above BRL 7m on 12 matches (2015)	1.2%	No top-flight anchor club
Nelson Mandela Bay Stadium	ZAR 2.1bn	Running costs estimated at ZAR 18m a year	0.9%	Build cost rose from ZAR 895m (2006)

Source: Wikipedia (pt) citing Estadão and Tribuna do Norte (Natal); Wikipedia citing Cape Town Stadium SOC annual report 2021-22; Mayor of London, The full cost of London Stadium (March 2018); Wikipedia venue articles (Beijing, Manaus, Nelson Mandela Bay); the Manaus match count and loss come from a single source (Wikipedia, pt). Share of build cost is **Heirstone analysis**; London uses £760m of build and conversion cost. Natal's payments include repayment of the private partner's construction finance and are not comparable with operating costs.

An anchor or a concession changes the arithmetic. Brasília's Mané Garrincha has been run by a private operator since December 2019 and sold its naming rights for BRL 7.5m over three years. Tokyo let Ariake Arena, built for ¥35bn, to a Dentsu-led consortium until March 2046 for a fixed ¥9.4bn, about 27% of the build cost, plus half of each year's pre-tax profit.



CHAPTER 4

04

Homes and districts carry the legacy

An athletes' village is a housing estate that opens with a fortnight of sport. After the event its flats still have buyers and tenants, which is why villages are the most dependable legacy in our benchmark.

According to Wikipedia, Barcelona's village is now a neighbourhood of 9,338 people. London's East Village houses more than 7,000, and Paris and Tokyo are filling theirs now. Athens is the weak case: 2,292 flats went to low-income buyers but, by the same source, only half of the village was ever sold.

Villages differ in density, timing and who carries the sale risk. Harumi Flag fits about 313 homes on each of its 18 hectares, three times the density of East Village and nearly six times that of the Paris village. Density is a choice about the district that follows, and it is made when the athletes' blocks are designed.

EXHIBIT 9

Tokyo's village is three times as dense as London's and six times as dense as Paris's

Homes after conversion per hectare of village site, gross

Harumi Flag, Tokyo 2020	313 per ha	5,632 units on 18 ha
East Village, London 2012	104 per ha	2,818 homes on 27 ha
Athletes' village, Paris 2024	54 per ha	2,807 homes on 52 ha
Vila Olímpica, Barcelona 1992	21 per ha	c.2,000 flats, 94 ha area
Media Village, Paris 2024	20 per ha	1,400 homes on 70 ha

Source: Wikipedia, Harumi Flag; Wikipedia citing The Observer (East Village); SOLIDEO village and media cluster pages; Wikipedia, La Vila Olímpica del Poblenou (whole neighbourhood area, so understated for the village itself). Heirstone analysis.

THE VILLAGES

Selling the homes before the Games took the risk off the public balance sheet

EXHIBIT 10

Seven villages, three ways of carrying the risk

Olympic and media villages: homes after the event, site, risk holder and occupation

VILLAGE	HOMES AFTER THE EVENT	SITE (HA)	WHO CARRIED THE RISK	OCCUPATION
East Village London 2012	2,818, of which 1,379 affordable	27	Pre-sold: affordable homes to Triathlon Homes for £268m (2009); market homes to Qatari Diar and Delancey for £557m (2011)	More than 7,000 residents today
Athletes' village Paris 2024	2,807	52	Four developer groups built each sector to convert; sectors returned in November 2024	Homes from 2025; 6,000 residents and 6,000 jobs targeted
Media Village Paris 2024	1,400	70	Supervised by SOLIDEO; 1,582 journalists housed at Games time	950 homes delivered in March 2024, before the Games
Harumi Flag Tokyo 2020	5,632, of which 4,145 for sale	18	Land sold to a Mitsui Fudosan-led consortium for about US\$87m; price challenge dismissed in 2021	Occupied from 19 January 2024; about 12,000 residents expected
Olympic Village Vancouver 2010	c.1,100, of which 252 affordable	n/v	City took on the CAD 630m development debt as lender of last resort	Debt repaid with CAD 70m recovered, April 2014
Athletes' village Rio 2016	3,604 in 31 buildings	n/v	Private developers Odebrecht and Carvalho Hosken	Sales and occupancy not published
Olympic Village Athens 2004	2,292 sold	n/v	Sold to low-income buyers	Over 8,000 residents; half the flats unsold (Wikipedia)

Source: NAO, London 2012 post-Games review (December 2012); Wikipedia, East Village, London; SOLIDEO sector pages (Universeine, Quinconces, Belvédères, Écoquartier fluvial, media cluster); Wikipedia, Harumi Flag; City of Vancouver, Olympic Village; Wikipedia, Rio 2016 Olympic Village and 2004 Summer Olympics (accessed 2026).

London sold both halves of its village before the Games: 1,379 affordable homes to Triathlon Homes for £268m in 2009 and 1,439 market homes to Qatari Diar and Delancey for £557m in 2011. The £825m total is about £293,000 a home, and it moved completion and sales risk off the public balance sheet before the athletes arrived. Vancouver kept the risk. The city became lender of last resort, took on the CAD 630m development debt and announced in April 2014 that it had repaid all of it and recovered CAD 70m more.

Tokyo sold the Harumi land to a consortium led by Mitsui Fudosan for about US\$87m. On our calculation that is about US\$483 per m² of land, or some US\$15,400 of

land for each of the 5,632 homes. Residents challenged the price as too low in a lawsuit that was dismissed in December 2021. Occupation began on 19 January 2024, two and a half years after Games that had themselves been delayed by a year.

Paris made reversibility a contract term. The Universeine sector, which held 5,850 athlete beds, was handed back in November 2024 and becomes 125,000 m² of mixed use with 2,500 Interior Ministry staff. A 130-unit student residence housed students before the Games, athletes during them and students again from the end of 2024. SOLIDEO reports 95% of its promised physical legacy delivered by the end of 2025, with the rest due by 2028.

£293k

recovered per home when London pre-sold its village for £825m

950

Paris Media Village homes delivered in March 2024, before the Games

US\$483

per m² paid for the Harumi village land (about US\$87m for 18 ha)

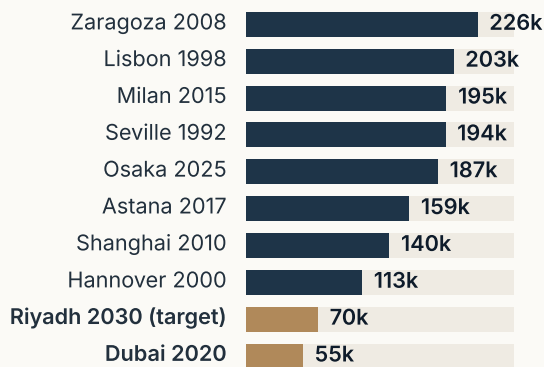
EXPO LAND

Expo sites fill over decades. Dubai laid out its site for the district that would follow.

EXHIBIT 11

Dubai used its site at a quarter of the usual Expo intensity

Visits per hectare of Expo site, thousands



Source: BIE Expo pages (site area and visitors); Expo 2030 Riyadh Company (6m m² site, 42m visits targeted). Lisbon uses the BIE's 50 ha. Heirstone analysis.

An Expo site is sized for six months of crowds. Dividing BIE visitor numbers by site area shows how hard each site was used. Lisbon, Seville, Milan and Zaragoza handled between about 194,000 and 226,000 visits per hectare. Dubai handled 55,030 across 438 hectares, about a quarter of that.

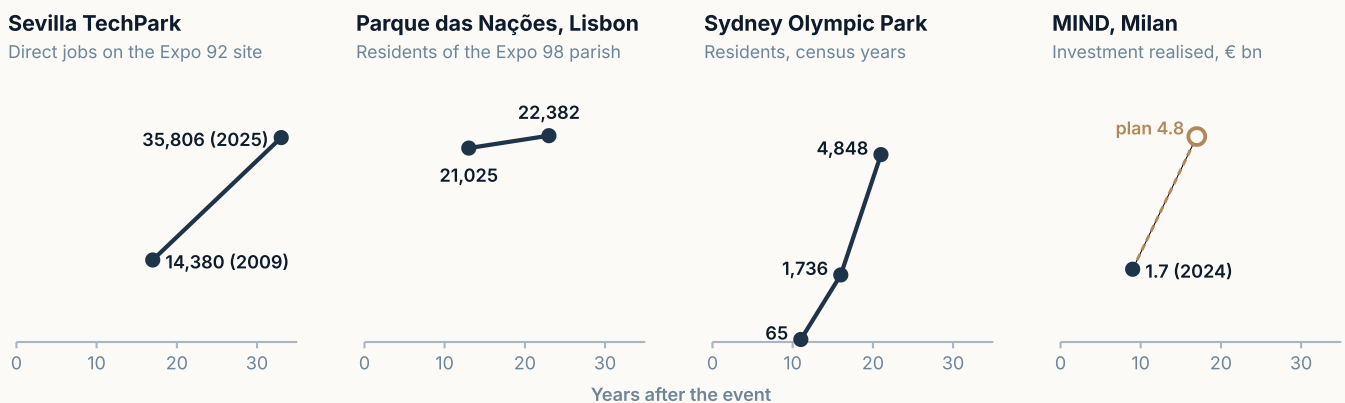
On this measure Expo 2020 was laid out for the district that would follow it, which fits with Expo City Dubai keeping more than 80% of the Expo's buildings and infrastructure and reopening six months after closing. Riyadh's 2030 site, 6 km² for 42 million targeted visits, would run at about 70,000 visits per hectare, close to Dubai's.

Expo City Dubai is early on its curve. It recorded 783,600 visitors in 2025, about 2,150 a day against some 132,400 a day during the Expo, and hosted 37 events. Tenant occupancy of its 135,000 m² of Grade A offices rose 34% during the year. It does not yet publish resident numbers against its target of 35,000.

EXHIBIT 12

Seville's jobs grew two and a half times between years 17 and 33

Measured outcomes on four former event sites by years after the event; MIND shown against its 2032 programme



Source: Wikipedia, Cartuja 93 (14,380 employed, 2009); Sevilla TechPark (35,806 direct jobs, 2025); INE census 2011 and 2021 via Wikipedia (Parque das Nações); ABS census via Wikipedia (Sydney Olympic Park); TEHA Group and Arexpo, MIND executive summary (May 2025). The two Seville figures come from different publishers.

Filling the district takes far longer than the event. Sevilla TechPark reports 602 companies and 35,806 direct jobs on the Expo 92 site, about 167 jobs per hectare and growth of about 6% a year since 2009. Lisbon's parish added 1,357 residents between 2011 and 2021, while its median sale price rose 75% from 2016 to 2023, to €5,013 per m².

Sydney Olympic Park had 65 residents 11 years after the Games and 4,848 after 21; its 2050 master plan now provides for 15,000 homes over 25 years. MIND had realised about 35% of its €4.8bn programme nine years after Milan's Expo. A district on an event site should be underwritten on an absorption curve of 15 to 30 years.

SUMMITS

Summit hosts now reuse event estates, with beds as the binding limit

EXHIBIT 13

Five of the six summits used an existing event or exhibition site; only Belém used a new one

Venue, origin and scale of recent climate summits and the 2023 G20 leaders' summit

SUMMIT	VENUE	ORIGIN OF THE VENUE	NEW BUILD	SCALE
COP26 Glasgow 2021	Scottish Event Campus	Existing convention campus	none	n/v
COP27 Sharm El Sheikh 2022	Sharm El Sheikh International Convention Centre	Existing convention centre	none	33,449 registered; 49,704 attended (Carbon Brief)
COP28 Dubai 2023	Expo City Dubai	Expo 2020 legacy site	Adapted Expo facilities	80,000+ accredited; about 400,000 in the Green Zone
G20 summit New Delhi 2023	Bharat Mandapam, Pragati Maidan	Exhibition grounds, rebuilt	₹2,700 crore complex; 7,000-seat hall	Hosts 70+ exhibitions a year
COP29 Baku 2024	Baku Olympic Stadium	2015 European Games stadium	112,000 m ² temporary venue beside it	About 80,000 expected
COP30 Belém 2025	Parque da Cidade	New park on a former airfield	R\$946.9m in contracts; up to R\$5bn in all	56,118 registered; 26,000 extra beds promised

Source: Wikipedia articles on the 2021 to 2025 UN Climate Change Conferences and on Bharat Mandapam, citing UNFCCC and press; Carbon Brief, COP27 delegates analysis, using UNFCCC data (accessed 2026). Participant figures use different bases: accredited, registered, attended or expected.

Recent summits show a shift to existing estates. COP28 went to Expo City Dubai 20 months after the Expo closed and was the largest climate summit to date, with more than 80,000 accredited participants and about 400,000 people admitted to the public Green Zone. COP29 in Baku used the stadium built for the 2015 European Games, with a 112,000 m² venue put up beside it. India held the 2023 G20 at Bharat Mandapam, a ₹2,700 crore convention complex on exhibition grounds that host more than 70 fairs a year. COP27 used Sharm El Sheikh's existing convention centre and, on Carbon Brief's count of 49,704 attendees, was the largest COP up to that time.

Belém took the other route. COP30 was held in a new public park on a former airfield. Contracts reached R\$946.9m and total spending may have reached R\$5bn, including cruise ships hired as hotels. In August 2025, three months before the summit, only 18 of 147 countries answering a UN survey had secured accommodation, and the host promised 26,000 extra beds.

For a legacy estate, a summit is a reuse revenue line. It needs halls, a secure perimeter, transport and power, which an Expo site or an Olympic park already has. The binding constraint is beds, which depend on the city's hotel and housing stock more than on the venue.

COP28 opened at Expo City Dubai 20 months after the Expo closed, on a site whose halls and transport links were already in place.

80,000+

accredited participants at COP28, the largest climate summit to date

18 of 147

countries had secured beds in Belém three months before COP30

CHAPTER 5

05

A day-two readiness scorecard

The benchmark points to a short list of decisions that separate fast reuse from slow. We have turned them into eight tests. Each asks whether a decision has been made and contracted, because the record shows that intentions announced at bid stage are often not carried out.

Each test scores 2 where the commitment is contracted and public, 1 where it is stated but not yet contracted, and 0 where we cannot find it. Tests that do not apply, such as seat removal for a district with no temporary seats, are left out of the total. We read 75% or more of the applicable points as ready, 40% to 74% as having gaps to close, and below 40% as early or not yet disclosed.

The tests are cheapest to pass before design freeze. After the event, most of them can only be passed by spending money: London's stadium conversion cost £274m.

EXHIBIT 14

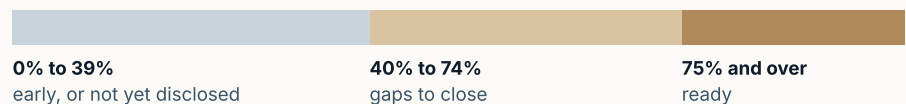
Eight tests, each tied to a case that met it and a case that missed it

The Heirstone day-two readiness scorecard

TEST	THE QUESTION TO ASK	MET IN THE BENCHMARK	MISSED IN THE BENCHMARK
1 Owner on day two	Is the post-event landowner, with its buyer or development partner, under contract before construction starts?	London pre-sold its village for £825m in 2009 and 2011; Lisbon funded its Expo largely through land sales.	Hellinikon's venues waited 16 years for redevelopment to start.
2 Anchor signed	Is a named principal tenant (club, university, institute or operator) contracted before opening?	Paris's Adidas Arena opened with its resident club five months before the Games.	Cape Town found its anchor in 2021, 11 years on; the city grant then fell 31%.
3 Day-two size	Is permanent capacity set on the average local crowd, with the event peak added as temporary seats?	London Aquatics: 2,800 permanent seats of 17,500.	Arena Pantanal: 879 average at the 2015 state championship in a 42,788-seat bowl, according to Wikipedia.
4 Removal funded	Are temporary seats and structures budgeted, contracted and dated for removal at award?	London's 12,000-seat basketball arena was gone by January 2013.	Rio's Future Arena stood unfunded in 2017; Stadium 974 still stands.
5 Built for the after-use	Are buildings designed first for their permanent use, with the event as an overlay?	Paris returned village sectors for conversion in November 2024; Expo City Dubai kept over 80% of the Expo.	London Stadium's conversion budget rose from £190m to £323m.
6 Reopening date	Is there a public date to reopen, within 12 months of closing?	Lisbon reopened in 15 days, Dubai in six months, part of London's park within a year.	Sydney Olympic Park had 65 residents 11 years after the Games.
7 Follow-on calendar	Are the first five years of events after the closing ceremony booked?	Expo City hosted COP28 at 20 months; Qatar's stadiums are booked to 2030.	Arena da Amazônia staged 12 matches in 2015, according to Wikipedia.
8 Absorption and reporting	Is the district phased on observed absorption, with outcomes published every year?	Sevilla TechPark publishes firms, jobs and output; LLDC publishes planning monitoring.	LLDC's own data show 4 net home completions in 2023-24 against 2,453 permitted.

Source: Heirstone framework, built from the Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026. Evidence from NAO (2012), SOLIDEO, LLDC monitoring 2023-24, Sevilla TechPark, Expo City Dubai, Wikipedia venue and site articles (accessed 2026).

READING THE TOTAL



2 of 8

tests, owner and anchor, that separate reuse within two and a half years from waits of three to 22 years (Exhibit 15)

£274m

spent converting the London Stadium for football from 2013 to 2016, the cost of meeting test 5 after the event

TESTING THE SCORECARD

Sites with their owner and use fixed before the event reopened within two and a half years. The rest took three to 22.

EXHIBIT 15

The two tests that matter most separate fast reuse from slow

Years from the event to the principal post-event use, benchmark sites grouped by whether owner (test 1) and anchor or use (test 2) were fixed before the event

OWNER AND USE FIXED BEFORE THE EVENT



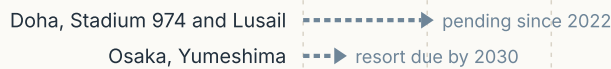
ANCHOR OR DEVELOPMENT PARTNER FOUND AFTER THE EVENT



NO ANCHOR FOUND YET



PLANNED CONVERSION NOT YET CARRIED OUT



Source: Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026; grouping is a Heirstone judgement on the public record at the time of each event. Cape Town's first operator signed before the event and withdrew in December 2010; its rugby anchor came in 2021. Sydney's venues stayed in event use from 2000; the row shows the residential district. Lisbon reopened on 15 October 1998, 15 days after closing; Dubai on 1 October 2022; Tokyo's Games were delayed by a year. Sydney shows residents at the 2011 and 2021 censuses; Hellinikon shows the start of works (2020) and the first park sections (2026).

We grouped the benchmark sites with a clear post-event milestone by what was in place when the event opened. The six sites whose owner and use were fixed in advance reached their main post-event use in a median of under a year and none took more than two and a half years. The six that found their anchor or development partner after the event took three to 22 years, half of them 11 years or more. Manaus has yet to find a club anchor.

The pattern rests on 15 cases and our reading of each, and other things

matter too. Saransk, a city of about 330,000, received a 44,442-seat stadium. Hellinikon sits on valuable coastal land and is now being redeveloped at scale, but only after its venues were demolished. Still, the two tests that best divide fast from slow are the two a host controls before construction starts.

The other six tests explain differences within the fast group. London passed the removal test but missed on stadium conversion, and paid £274m for it, which is why the scorecard keeps all eight.

<1 year

median time to main post-event use where owner and use were fixed in advance

3 to 22 years

to main use where the anchor or development partner came after the event

CHAPTER 6

06

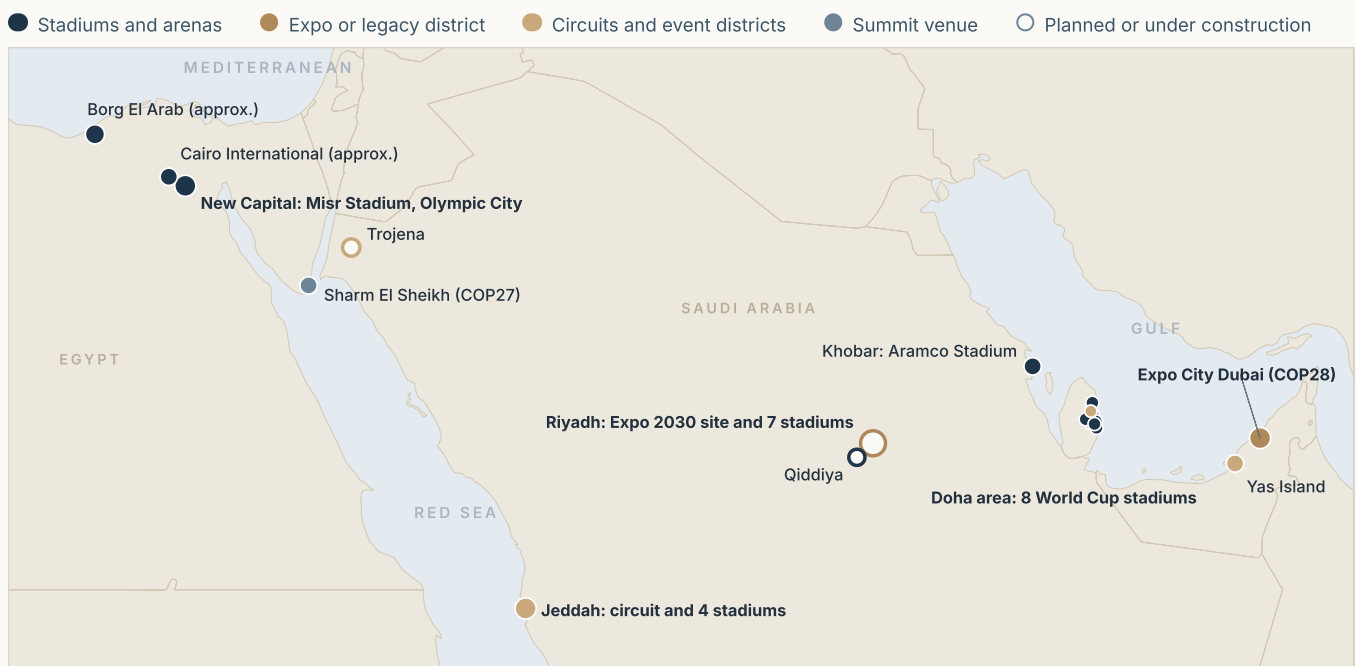
The Gulf and Egypt

Saudi Arabia, Qatar and the UAE hold between them an Expo, a World Cup, two Asian Games and a run of annual events to 2034. Egypt, which hosted the Africa Cup of Nations finals in 2006 and 2019 and COP27 in 2022, holds about 255,000 seats in its three largest stadiums.

EXHIBIT 16

The region's event sites cluster in five cities and the Egyptian capital region

Selected event venues and legacy sites in Saudi Arabia, Qatar, the UAE and Egypt, 2026



Source: Expo 2030 Riyadh Company; Expo City Dubai; Wikipedia stadium, circuit and summit articles (accessed 2026). Expo 2030 Riyadh is plotted at King Salman International Stadium, its stated neighbour. Positions for Cairo International and Borg El Arab, and the grouping of Riyadh and Jeddah stadiums, are approximate. Abha (one renovated 2034 stadium) lies south of the map.

2027

AFC Asian Cup in Saudi Arabia (January); FIFA World Cup in Doha

2025-29

FIFA U-17 World Cup in Qatar every year

2028

Saudi Grand Prix planned to move to Qiddiya Speed Park

2030

Asian Games in Doha (November); Expo 2030 Riyadh opens in October

2031

Riyadh Expo site to become the Global Village after March

2034

Asian Games in Riyadh; World Cup in Saudi Arabia, possibly January 2035

The region has already run one of the benchmark's fastest Expo conversions and its most closely watched stadium legacy plan. The next decade adds ten new World Cup stadiums and a 6 km² Expo site in Saudi Arabia, and Egypt can set the long-term programme for its new national stadium and Olympic City now, ahead of the Olympic bid it has signalled for 2036 or 2040.

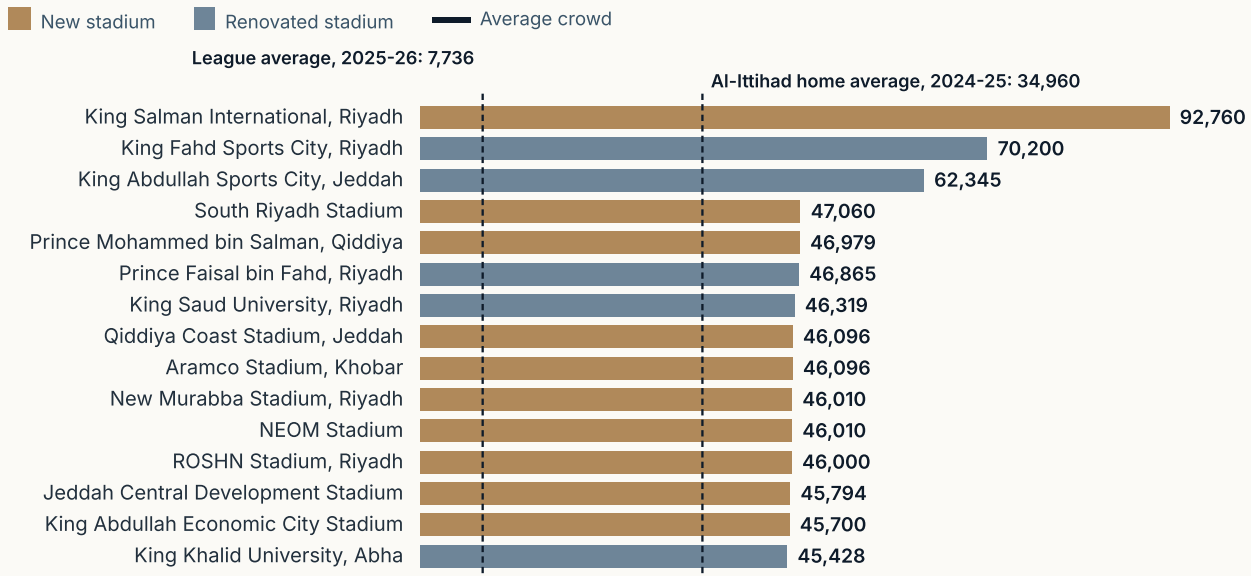
SAUDI ARABIA 2034

Ten new stadiums add 508,505 seats; league crowds average about 8,000

EXHIBIT 17

Most of the new bowls hold about 46,000, six times the league's average crowd

2034 World Cup stadiums by capacity in the tournament listing, with Saudi Pro League attendance



Source: Wikipedia, 2034 FIFA World Cup (citing BBC Sport and FIFA, December 2024); Wikipedia, 2024-25 and 2025-26 Saudi Pro League. The bid article lists 11 new and 4 renovated stadiums; the tournament article 10 and 5. Totals are Heirstone analysis.

FIFA confirmed Saudi Arabia as sole host of the 2034 World Cup in December 2024, with 15 stadiums in Riyadh, Jeddah, Khobar, NEOM and Abha. Ten are new and total 508,505 seats. Nine of them hold between 45,700 and 47,060; the tenth, the 92,760-seat King Salman International Stadium in north Riyadh, is due in the fourth quarter of 2029 and is to become the national team's home.

League football will fill a small part of that capacity. The Saudi Pro League averaged 8,159 in 2023-24, 8,355 in 2024-25 and 7,736 in 2025-26, when it played about 300 matches. In 2024-25 Al-Ittihad, its best-supported club, averaged 34,960 at King Abdullah Sports City, while Al-Fayha averaged 1,443.

Several of the new venues are designed for a wider calendar. Prince

Mohammed bin Salman Stadium at Qiddiya, begun in December 2024, combines a retractable roof, a retractable pitch and an LED wall, and names Al-Nassr and Al-Hilal as planned tenants. Aramco Stadium in Khobar, a SAR 3.7bn project, is owned by ROSHN and run by Aramco on a 25-year concession with Al-Qadsiah as tenant; it is the only new venue among the eight used for the 2027 Asian Cup.

The calendar is full until 2034: the Asian Cup in January 2027, Expo 2030 from October 2030, and the Asian Games in Riyadh from 29 November 2034, which may push the World Cup into January 2035. The day-two test for the other new stadiums comes after that, and it depends on the tenants and second uses written into their briefs now.

508,505

seats in the ten new 2034 stadiums, of 779,662 across all 15

17%

of a 46,000-seat bowl filled by the league's 2025-26 average of 7,736

180 days

to build Riyadh's 26,090-seat Kingdom Arena in 2023

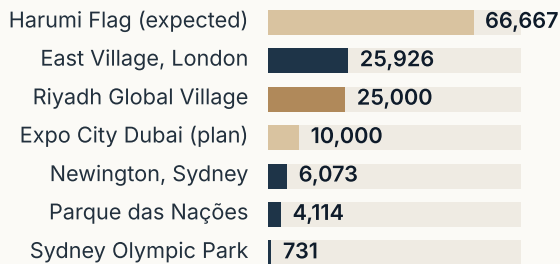
RIYADH AND DUBAI

Riyadh plans East Village density across an Expo-sized site

EXHIBIT 18

Riyadh's Global Village would match East Village density on 22 times the area

Residents per km² on former event sites, achieved and planned



Source: Expo 2030 Riyadh Company (150,000 residents, 6 km²); Expo City Dubai master plan (35,000, 3.5 km²); Wikipedia citing census data (East Village 7,000+ on 27 ha; Newington 5,648 on 0.93 km²; Parque das Nações 22,382 on 5.44 km²; Sydney Olympic Park 4,848 on 6.63 km²); Harumi 12,000 expected on 18 ha. **Heirstone analysis.** Gold: planned or expected.

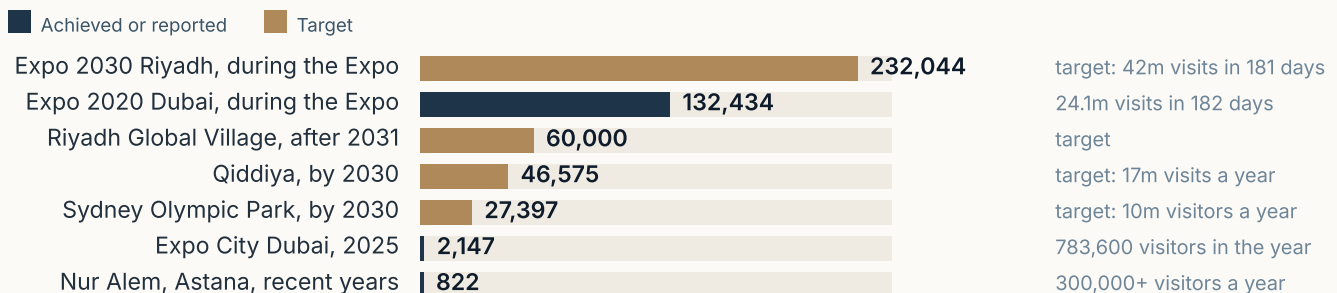
Expo 2030 Riyadh runs for 181 days from 1 October 2030 on a 6 km² site in north Riyadh, one metro stop from King Khalid International Airport and beside King Salman Stadium. The organiser expects more than 42 million visits, about 232,000 a day. After March 2031 the site is to become a permanent Global Village for 150,000 residents and 60,000 daily visitors.

Both targets are demanding against the benchmark. 150,000 residents on 6 km² is 25,000 people per km², the density of London's East Village spread over an area 22 times larger and two and a half times Expo City Dubai's plan. 60,000 daily visitors would be about 26% of the Expo's own daily average and 28 times the daily footfall Expo City Dubai recorded in 2025.

EXHIBIT 19

Riyadh's day-two visitor target is 28 times what Expo City Dubai drew in 2025

Visitors per day: averages during an Expo, and outcomes and targets on event sites after the event



Source: Expo 2030 Riyadh Company (42m visits; 60,000 daily visitors after March 2031); BIE (Expo 2020 Dubai visits); Expo City Dubai Sustainability Report 2025; Wikipedia, Qiddiya and Sydney Olympic Park (citing Master Plan 2030); BIE, Expo 2017 Astana (Nur Alem). Annual figures divided by 365. **Heirstone analysis.**

Expo City Dubai drew about 2,150 visitors a day in 2025; its value so far comes from offices, homes, a free zone with more than 2,000 licensable activities and events such as COP28. The nearest regional comparator for Riyadh's target is Qiddiya, which aims for 17 million visits a year by 2030 from theme parks, a motor-racing circuit and a stadium.

Yas Island shows how long such a destination takes. Abu Dhabi opened a US\$1.32bn Formula One circuit there in 2009, then added Ferrari World (2010), Warner Bros.

World (2018), the 18,000-seat Etihad Arena (2021) and SeaWorld (2023); a Disney park was announced in May 2025.

Event calendars also move. The Olympic Council of Asia awarded the 2029 Asian Winter Games to Trojena in October 2022, postponed them in January 2026 and named Almaty as host in February 2026. Any venue planned around one marquee event should have a day-two case that can be tested without it.

EGYPT

Egypt already has the seats, and a record of staging a tournament at five months' notice

EXHIBIT 20

Egypt's three largest stadiums seat about 255,000 between them

Capacity of Egypt's main stadiums and arenas, seats

Misr Stadium, New Capital	93,940	Opened 2024; expected to be the national stadium
Borg El Arab Stadium	86,000	Opened 2009; hosted the FIFA U-20 World Cup
Cairo International Stadium	75,000	Opened 1960; AFCON finals 2006 and 2019
Cairo Stadium Indoor Halls	16,900	Main hall; opened for the 1991 All-Africa Games
Olympic City main arena	15,000	Planned indoor arena (single source)
New Capital Sports Hall	7,500	Opened 2021; hosted the World Handball Championship

Source: Wikipedia articles on Misr Stadium, Borg El Arab Stadium, Cairo International Stadium, Cairo Stadium Indoor Halls Complex, New Capital Sports Hall and the 2021 World Men's Handball Championship, citing CAF, StadiumDB and Egyptian press (accessed 2026). The Olympic City arena capacity comes from a single source (Wikipedia).

Cairo International Stadium opened in 1960, seats 75,000 and hosted the Africa Cup of Nations finals in 2006 and 2019. Borg El Arab, west of Alexandria, opened in 2009 with 86,000 seats and hosted the FIFA U-20 World Cup that year. Misr Stadium in the New Administrative Capital, 93,940 seats, opened in March 2024 and is expected to replace Cairo International as the national stadium.

The stock has proved its worth at short notice. CAF named Egypt host of the 2019 Africa Cup of Nations on 8 January 2019; the 24-team tournament opened on 21 June in six existing stadiums and drew 943,053 spectators across 52 matches. A country with large stadiums, hotel stock and a record of staging a 24-team tournament at five months' notice can offer itself as a host for events that need a venue at short

notice, and each such booking adds to the calendar its stadiums need.

The Egypt International Olympic City, about 45 km east of Cairo, has more than 22 sporting facilities, built in phases since 2015. Egypt has said it aims to be Africa's first Olympic host, and ANOCA's head said in 2024 that it was bidding for 2036 and 2040. The IOC paused its future-host process for review in June 2025, which gives Egypt time to set the Olympic City's day-two programme now: an anchor tenant for Misr Stadium, a calendar of continental events and training use by national teams.

Sharm El Sheikh shows the summit route. It hosted COP27 in 2022 at its existing convention centre, and Carbon Brief's count of 49,704 attendees made it the largest COP up to that time. The resort received more than 3 million visitors in 2024, according to Wikipedia.

c.5 months

between CAF naming Egypt as 2019 host and the opening match, played in existing stadiums

93,940

seats at Misr Stadium in the New Administrative Capital, opened in March 2024 and expected to become the national stadium

22+

sporting facilities at the Olympic City, 45 km east of Cairo

THE SCORECARD APPLIED

What the public record shows about day two across the regional pipeline

EXHIBIT 21

Sites past their event score highest; among the 2034 stadiums, the one with a named owner, operator and club leads

Heirstone day-two readiness scorecard applied to regional event sites on public information, 2026

SITE	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	POINTS FOUND
Expo 2030 Riyadh, Global Village Saudi Arabia	○	○	●	○	●	●	○	○	4 of 16
King Salman International Stadium Saudi Arabia	○	●	○	n/a	○	n/a	○	○	1 of 12
Prince Mohammed bin Salman Stadium Saudi Arabia	○	●	○	n/a	●	n/a	○	○	3 of 12
Aramco Stadium, Khobar Saudi Arabia	●	●	○	n/a	○	n/a	●	○	5 of 12
Seven other new 2034 stadiums Saudi Arabia	●	○	○	n/a	○	n/a	○	○	1 of 12
Seven new 2022 stadiums Qatar	n/a	●	●	○	●	n/a	●	○	7 of 12
Expo City Dubai UAE	●	●	●	n/a	●	●	●	●	12 of 14
Misir Stadium and Olympic City Egypt	○	●	○	n/a	○	n/a	○	○	1 of 12

● commitment published or in operation ● stated or partly in place ○ not found in public sources n/a: test does not apply

Tests: 1 owner on day two, 2 anchor signed, 3 day-two size, 4 removal funded, 5 built for the after-use, 6 reopening date, 7 follow-on calendar, 8 absorption and reporting.

Source: Heirstone analysis using the sources cited in chapters 3, 4 and 6: Expo 2030 Riyadh Company; BIE; Expo City Dubai master plan and Sustainability Report 2025; Qatar 2022 Supreme Committee; Wikipedia stadium and tournament articles. Points found: 2 for a published commitment, 1 for a stated or partial one, out of the maximum for applicable tests.

The scores record what has been disclosed. An empty mark means only that we could not find the commitment in public sources by 2026, and several of these projects are four to eight years from their event. Read that way, the table lists the documents that lenders and prospective tenants are likely to ask for.

Expo City Dubai meets or partly meets every applicable test, as an operating district with a published master plan and an annual sustainability report should. Qatar's stadiums score on tenants, planned size and calendar, and lose points on removal and reporting. Among the

2034 stadiums, Aramco Stadium has a named owner, operator and club, and Prince Mohammed bin Salman Stadium has two planned club tenants and a multi-use design. Expo 2030 Riyadh has published its central day-two numbers; the next documents to look for are the district's owner and partners, its anchor tenants and a reopening date.

The commonest gap is the last test. In the sources we reviewed, no event site in the region publishes residents, occupancy, events and subsidy each year, as Sevilla TechPark and London's legacy corporation do.

12 of 14

points found for Expo City Dubai, the only district in the table already past its event

0 of 8

sites we found publishing residents, occupancy, events and subsidy every year

2024

Misir Stadium opened. It and the Olympic City were not built for one dated event, so the two event-date tests do not apply; AFCON 2019, staged at five months' notice, gives Egypt a record to build their calendar on

CHAPTER 7

07

What to settle before design freeze

Most of the decisions that shape an event site's second life cost little before design freeze and a great deal after it. These are the actions the benchmark supports, by audience, each with the case behind it.

For the Gulf and Egypt the timing is favourable. Expo 2030 Riyadh and the 2034 stadiums are before design freeze or in early construction, Qatar's larger bowls face a choice between seat removal and a longer calendar after 2030, and Egypt can programme its Olympic City now, independently of the Games timetable.

HOW HEIRSTONE WORKS ON EVENT SITES

We help landowners, master developers, investors and event hosts plan event sites for the years after the event: highest-and-best-use and legacy studies, demand and absorption analysis, feasibility and business models (DCF, IRR, NPV and Monte Carlo testing), masterplanning and phasing, and benchmarking of the kind in this report.

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GOVERNMENTS AND LAND AGENCIES

- 1 Write the day-two owner, anchor and permanent seat count into the host agreement, with a published reopening date.
Lisbon reopened in 15 days and Dubai in six months; Hellinikon waited 16 years.
- 2 Fund removal at award: no temporary seat or structure without a buyer, a contractor and a date.
London's basketball arena was gone by January 2013; Rio's Future Arena had no demolition budget.
- 3 Publish day-two outcomes every year: residents, jobs, occupancy, events and subsidy.
Sevilla TechPark and London's legacy corporation already do; we found no regional site that does.
- 4 Put summits on existing estates and spend on beds and transport.
COP27 used Sharm El Sheikh's convention centre and COP28 Expo City Dubai; Belém needed 26,000 extra beds.

BID COMMITTEES AND ORGANISERS

- 5 Size permanent seats on the average local crowd and add the peak as temporary capacity.
Saudi league crowds average 7,736; London Aquatics kept 2,800 of 17,500 seats.
- 6 Test each venue for portability: what it is worth if the anchor event moves.
The OCA moved the 2029 Asian Winter Games from Trojena to Almaty in February 2026.
- 7 Use existing and temporary venues where a city has no day-two tenant.
Los Angeles 1984 and Paris 2024, the two surpluses in our data, built little.

MASTER DEVELOPERS AND OPERATORS

- 8 Design the village and media housing as the district's first phase, and deliver some homes before the event.
Paris delivered 950 Media Village homes in March 2024.
- 9 Sign an education or research anchor before construction.
Universities or schools took space at seven or more of the 30 benchmark sites.
- 10 Concession venues for a fixed fee plus a share of profit.
Ariake Arena: ¥9.4bn fixed, about 27% of cost, plus 50% of pre-tax profit to 2046.

INVESTORS AND LENDERS

- 11 Underwrite on outturn cost, with an allowance for later revision.
Every Games with data overran, by 156% on average; Rio's cost was revised threefold.
- 12 Price the subsidy line: public stadium owners in our data carried about 1% to 2% of build cost a year.
Beijing 2.1%, Cape Town 1.4% before its anchor, London 1.3%.
- 13 Phase district finance on an absorption curve of 15 to 30 years, and treat village pre-sales as the first exit.
MIND realised about 35% of its programme in nine years; London pre-sold its village for £825m.

IMPLEMENTATION

A day-two timeline, from bid to the second year after closing

The eight tests are not passed at one moment. Each has a point in the event programme after which passing it gets expensive. The timeline sets each test against that point and against the benchmark case that shows it can be done.

STAGE	WHAT TO SETTLE	TESTS	BENCHMARK CASE
Bid Seven to nine years out	Name the day-two owner and the permanent capacity of each venue. For an Expo, the post-Expo plan must sit in the BIE registration dossier at least five years before opening.	1, 3	Riyadh's dossier, approved by the BIE in June 2025, carries its Global Village plan.
Award Host contract signed	Sign the district partner and the anchor tenants. Contract and fund the removal of temporary seats, with dates.	1, 2, 4	London sold its village in 2009 and 2011, before the Games.
Design freeze Before construction	Design permanent buildings for their after-use, with the event as an overlay: floor plates, cores and services for homes or offices.	3, 5	Paris built village sectors to convert and handed them back in November 2024.
Opening The event begins	Anchor tenants in residence; the first five years of events booked.	2, 7	Adidas Arena opened with its resident club five months before the Games.
Closing + 6 months First reopening	Hand back village sectors for conversion and reopen part of the site to the public.	6	Expo City Dubai opened on 1 October 2022, six months after the Expo closed.
Closing + 2 years And every year after	Publish residents, jobs, occupancy, events and subsidy. Re-phase the district on observed absorption.	8	Sevilla TechPark reports firms, jobs and output 33 years on.

EXHIBIT 22

The widest spreads in the benchmark are in crowds, density and time to reuse

Range observed across the Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark, by measure, with the case at each end and the regional reference point

MEASURE	LOW	CASE	HIGH	CASE	REGIONAL REFERENCE
Years from closing to main post-event use	0	Hannover (continuous); Lisbon, 15 days	22	Hellinikon, first park sections	2.4 years at most where owner and use were fixed in advance
Permanent seats kept after the event	16%	London Aquatics Centre	94%	Volgograd Arena	Saudi 2034: no published downsizing
Average crowd as a share of seats	2.1%	Arena Pantanal, 2015	56.2%	Al-Ittihad, 2024-25	Saudi Pro League average in a 46,000-seat bowl: 16.8%
Annual cost of a stadium, share of build cost	0.9%	Nelson Mandela Bay	2.1%	Beijing National Stadium	Natal partnership payments: 30% a year for 11 years
Village homes per hectare	20	Paris Media Village	313	Harumi Flag	Paris Athletes' Village: 54
Expo visits per hectare	55,030	Dubai 2020	226,038	Zaragoza 2008	Riyadh 2030 target: about 70,000
Residents per km ² on event land	731	Sydney Olympic Park, 2021	25,926	East Village, London	Riyadh Global Village plan: 25,000

Source: Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark 2026 and Exhibits 5, 7, 8, 9, 11, 15 and 18, with the sources given there. Ranges cover achieved outcomes only; regional figures in the last column are plans or targets where stated. **Heirstone analysis.**

NOTES, SOURCES AND DEFINITIONS

Notes

Definitions

Day two: the period after an event closes, when its site and venues must find permanent uses. **Main post-event use:** the principal permanent use of a site, such as a district's first residents or tenants, a stadium's anchor tenant or a cleared site's redevelopment. **Years to main use:** calendar years from the event to the opening of that use. **Legacy capacity:** seats after conversion, or planned seats where marked. **Visits per hectare:** BIE visitor total divided by BIE site area. **Density:** residents divided by gross site or district area. **Points found:** the scorecard total from public information, out of the maximum for the tests that apply.

Method

The Heirstone Day-Two Benchmark covers 30 Olympic, Expo and World Cup sites from 1992 to 2025, chosen to include frequently cited successes and failures, the Gulf's recent events and a spread of regions. Figures are as published, in the currency and period stated; we have not converted currencies, and US\$ figures for non-US venues are as reported by the source. Where we derive a figure (per seat, per home, per hectare, shares and growth rates) it is labelled Heirstone analysis and uses only the published inputs shown. Planned figures are shown as plans, not outcomes. Where sources conflict we give the range or the more conservative figure and say so; single-source claims are attributed in the text. Legacy models and scorecard marks are Heirstone judgements on the public record in 2026 and record only what had been published by then.

Use of this report

This report is published for general information. It takes no position on the merits of any host, event or government, and it is not investment, legal or valuation advice. © Heirstone Consulting L.L.C-FZ, 2026. Images are illustrative.

BENCHMARK (CHAPTER 1)

BIE Expo pages (Seville, Lisbon, Hannover, Zaragoza, Shanghai, Milan, Astana, Dubai, Osaka); SOLIDEO (ouvrages-olympiques.fr); LLDC, Our story and Planning Authority Monitoring 2023-24; Sydney Olympic Park Authority, About us and Master Plan 2050; Lamda Development, The Ellinikon; Sevilla TechPark; Arexpo, MIND; Expo City Dubai master plan brochure; Wikipedia site, village and venue articles citing ABS and INE census data, organisers and press (accessed 2026).

COST (CHAPTER 2)

Flyvbjerg, Stewart and Budzier, The Oxford Olympics Study 2016 (Saïd Business School); Flyvbjerg, Budzier and Lunn, Regression to the Tail (Environment and Planning A, 2020); NAO, London 2012 post-Games review (2012); Wikipedia articles on the 1984, 2004, 2014, 2016, 2020, 2024, 2028 and 2032 Games, Expo 2000, Expo 2015 and Expo 2025, citing organisers, audit bodies and press.

SEATS (CHAPTER 3)

NAO (2012); SOLIDEO venue pages; Qatar 2022 Supreme Committee stadium pages; Mayor of London, The full cost of London Stadium (2018); Wikipedia venue, league and tournament articles citing FIFA, AFC, CAF, clubs, Estádio, Tribuna do Norte and the Cape Town Stadium annual report 2021-22.

HOMES, DISTRICTS AND SUMMITS (CHAPTER 4)

NAO (2012); SOLIDEO sector pages; City of Vancouver, Olympic Village; TEHA Group and Arexpo, MIND executive summary (May 2025); Human Technopole; Expo City Dubai Sustainability Report 2025; Wikipedia articles on Harumi Flag, East Village, Cartuja 93, Parque das Nações, the 2021 to 2025 UN climate conferences and Bharat Mandapam; Carbon Brief, COP27 delegates analysis (UNFCCC data).

REGION (CHAPTERS 5 AND 6)

Expo 2030 Riyadh Company (site, legacy and news pages); BIE, Expo 2030 Riyadh and How to organise an Expo; Expo City Dubai business and living pages and Sustainability Report 2025; Wikipedia articles on the 2034 World Cup and its stadiums, Saudi Pro League seasons 2023-24 to 2025-26, Kingdom Arena, Jeddah Corniche Circuit, Qiddiya, Qiddiya Speed Park, Yas Island, Lusail and Qatar stadiums, the 2023 Asian Cup, 2025 Arab Cup, 2030 Asian Games, 2029 Asian Winter Games, Misr Stadium, Borg El Arab, Cairo International Stadium, New Capital Sports Hall, the 2019 Africa Cup of Nations, the 2021 World Men's Handball Championship and the 2036 Olympic bids, citing FIFA, OCA, CAF, IOC, ANOCA and press.

Derived figures and their inputs (Heirstone analysis)

Cost per event seat (Ex. 4): reported build cost divided by event capacity, e.g. Arena da Amazônia US\$270m / 42,924 = US\$6,290.

Share of seats kept (Ex. 5): legacy seats divided by event seats, e.g. London Aquatics Centre 2,800 / 17,500 = 16%.

Qatar planned cut (Ex. 6): (380,374 tournament seats less 160,200 planned legacy seats) / 380,374 = 57.9%.

Crowd as a share of seats (Ex. 7): average or single-match attendance divided by capacity, e.g. 7,736 / 46,000 = 16.8%.

Annual cost share (Ex. 8): annual payment, loss or running cost divided by build cost; London uses £486m + £274m.

London village proceeds per home: (£268m + £557m) / 2,818 homes = about £293,000.

Harumi land price: US\$87m / 180,000 m² = about US\$483 per m².

Homes per hectare (Ex. 9): homes after conversion divided by site area, e.g. 5,632 / 18 ha = 313.

Visits per hectare (Ex. 11): BIE visitors divided by BIE site area; Riyadh uses 42m targeted visits on 600 ha.

Visitors per day (Ex. 19): visits divided by days open, or annual visitors divided by 365.

Residents per km² (Ex. 18): residents divided by site or district area.

2034 seat totals (Ex. 17): sum of tournament-listing capacities: 779,662 for 15 stadiums, 508,505 for the 10 new ones.

Seville job growth (Ex. 12): (35,806 / 14,380) to the power 1/16, less 1 = about 6% a year, 2009 to 2025.

Egypt seats: Misr Stadium 93,940 + Borg El Arab 86,000 + Cairo International 75,000 = 254,940.



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